Notice to All Airside Pass Holders: Replacement of Laminated Passes with GateKey Smart Passes

Sirilom Airports Company Limited · Mukdahan Regional Airport · Circular AVSEC-CIR-2026-07 · Issued 1 October 2026

To: All holders of a Mukdahan Regional Airport identification pass, and the pass sponsors of every employer operating at the airport.
From: Somkiat Laorattana, Head of Aviation Security, Sirilom Airports Company Limited
Subject: Mandatory re-issue of all identification passes between November 2026 and January 2027

1. Why passes are being replaced

Since the terminal opened in 2019, Mukdahan Regional Airport has used laminated photo passes in three colours (green, blue and yellow). These passes cannot be cancelled remotely when lost. The airport is therefore moving to the GateKey airside pass system, in which every pass carries a contactless chip checked at each staff security door and vehicle gate.

About 1,340 people currently hold a laminated pass. Every one of them must attend a short re-issue appointment in person; there is no automatic conversion and no postal option.

Laminated passes remain valid until **31 January 2027 at 23:59**. From 1 February 2027 a laminated pass will not be accepted at any staff checkpoint, and a holder without a GateKey pass will be refused entry even if he or she is on duty.

2. Re-issue waves

To keep queues short, holders are called in three waves according to their employer.

- **Wave A** – Sirilom Airports staff, including Aviation Security, Airport Rescue and Fire Fighting, and the Maintenance Department: Monday 2 November to Friday 20 November 2026.
- **Wave B** – airlines, ground handling companies and the airport's two cargo agents: Monday 23 November to Friday 18 December 2026.
- **Wave C** – concessionaires (shops, cafés and the currency exchange counter), the fuel farm operator, and cleaning, catering and building contractors: Monday 4 January to Friday 22 January 2027.

Appointments take place at the Pass Office, **Room G-14 on the ground floor of the Administration Building**, next to the staff car park entrance. The Pass Office is open for re-issue appointments Monday to Friday from 08:30 to 15:30, closed for lunch from 12:00 to 13:00. Two extra Saturday sessions, from 09:00 to 12:00, will be held on 5 December 2026 for Wave B and on 16 January 2027 for Wave C. Walk-in visits are not served.

> **Note.** The former Pass Office counter in the landside arrivals hall (Room T-03) closed permanently on 30 September 2026.

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3. What the pass sponsor must do before the appointment

Before a holder can be booked, the employer's pass sponsor must complete the following steps in the GateKey sponsor portal:

1. Submit a re-issue request for the holder at least 10 working days before the chosen appointment date. Requests submitted later can only be booked in the last three days of the wave, if places remain.
2. Upload a criminal background check certificate issued no more than 6 months before the appointment date. Until this circular, certificates up to 12 months old were accepted; the 12-month rule no longer applies to any request.
3. Confirm that the holder has completed the online module "AVSEC Basic 2026" within the last 90 days.
4. Select the zones the holder needs for his or her actual duties (see section 5).

The Pass Office checks each request within 3 working days and returns incomplete requests to the sponsor with the reason shown.

4. At the appointment

The holder must bring his or her Thai national identity card or, for foreign staff, a passport with a valid work permit, together with the old laminated pass, which is surrendered and cut at the desk. The appointment takes about 20 minutes, and the pass is printed and activated while the holder waits.

A holder who cannot show the old pass is treated as having lost it (see section 8).

5. New zone system

GateKey passes do not use colours; the zone numbers a holder may enter are printed in large figures on the front of the pass and stored on the chip:

- Zone 1: apron, aircraft stands and airside roads.
- Zone 2: baggage make-up hall and the hold-baggage screening room.
- Zone 3: departure sterile area after passenger screening, including the gate lounges.
- Zone 4: terminal back offices, plant rooms and the landside service corridor.

Zones are granted according to the duties stated by the sponsor, not according to the colour of the old pass. Any zone that a holder has not used for 90 consecutive days is removed automatically from the chip, and the sponsor must request it again if it is still needed.

A GateKey holder with Zone 1 access may escort visitors who hold a daily visitor pass, up to a maximum of 2 visitors at the same time. Holders whose pass was issued less than 3 months earlier may not act as escorts.

6. Missing your wave

A holder who is not re-issued during his or her own wave may still be booked later, but a late re-issue surcharge applies (see section 7). The surcharge is waived in only two cases:

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- the holder joined the employer after the wave had closed, as shown by the employment start date in the sponsor portal; or
- the sponsor uploads a leave record showing that the holder was absent for at least 15 consecutive calendar days falling within the dates of the wave, for example maternity leave, long sick leave or an overseas training course.

Shorter absences, including ordinary annual leave, do not qualify for the waiver. Holders who return from long leave after 31 January 2027 cannot use their laminated pass at all and must be booked as soon as they return; until then they may only enter airside areas under escort with a visitor pass.

7. Fees

The following fees apply to all GateKey passes issued from 2 November 2026. They are billed to the employer, not to the individual holder, on the monthly airport services invoice.

- Standard GateKey pass for employees of airlines, ground handlers, cargo agents, concessionaires and the fuel farm operator: 350 baht per pass, valid for 3 years.
- Sirilom Airports staff: no charge.
- Contractor pass, valid for the length of the contract up to a maximum of 6 months: 500 baht per pass.
- Late re-issue surcharge, for a holder re-issued after his or her own wave has closed without a waiver: 200 baht per pass, in addition to the pass fee.
- Daily visitor pass: 50 baht per visitor per day, with a limit of 5 visitor days per person in any calendar year.

8. Lost, stolen and damaged passes

A lost or stolen GateKey pass must be reported to the Aviation Security Control Room immediately, on internal extension 2299. The sponsor must then file a written loss report in the portal within 24 hours.

- Replacement after a first loss: 1,000 baht. Until 30 September 2026 the fee for a lost laminated pass was 600 baht; the higher fee applies to every loss reported from 1 October 2026, including losses of old laminated passes.
- Replacement after a second loss by the same holder within 24 months: 2,500 baht, and the case is referred to the Head of Aviation Security, who may suspend the holder's airside access for up to 30 days.
- Damaged pass, where the damaged pass is handed back: 150 baht.

9. Scope and contacts

The GateKey pass does not replace the staff car park sticker, which remains under the Facilities Department and will be dealt with in a separate notice. Questions about bookings, sponsor requests and fees should be sent to the Pass Office Manager, Pornthip Khunthaisong, on internal extension 2214. Questions about zone decisions, escort rules and suspensions should be addressed to the Head of Aviation Security, Somkiat Laorattana, on extension 2201. Sponsors are asked to pass this notice on to all their pass holders by 15 October 2026.

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